

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Saturday May 20, 2023, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 8:30 a.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward II Councilor James Contois  
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne entered at 10:21am  
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone  
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau  
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski  
At-Large Councilor William Limoges  
At-Large Councilor Spencer Batchelder  
At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian  
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager  
Dane Mulholland, Finance Director

#### **AGENDA CHANGES**

None.

#### **CITIZEN’S FORUM**

None.

#### Fire

Fire Chief Chamberlain presented the Fire Budget.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated her hopes in having the fire station equipped for females in the near future. Chief Chamberlain explained there is \$100,000.00 in the capital reserve to make the fire department more inclusive.

Mayor Girard noted concern for the airport manager in the fire department budget when there is a separate airport budget. Manager Manale explained the Finance Director is looking to transfer that item into the airport budget.

Mayor Girard made note of the extra funds for training, Chief Chamberlain explained the estimated amount to onboard two call firefighters as well as going through the lieutenant promotional process is approximately \$60-\$100, the remaining will be for training.

Mayor Girard also shared concern for having two-line items for traffic lights, Chief Chamberlain noted the second line item is for the electrical services as each traffic signal has its own meter.

Councilor Koloski mentioned concerns for traffic signals, and would like to see management add additional funds for traffic signals.

Manager Manale stated the Finance Director suggests taking \$103,531.00 from the regular pay line in salaries, and \$40,000.00 from transferring out the airport manager.

Director Mulholland noted there was an extra position in the salary line and that is why it can be reduced.

**Council agrees by consensus to increase escrow for traffic signals to \$10,000.00, and add the \$3,500.00 for the training line.**

**A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to tentatively approve the Fire Budget for \$2,644,135.00**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian- yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**

**Koloski - yes**

**Matteau - yes**

**Stone -yes**

**Batchelder - yes**

**Girard - yes**

**Motion Carried 8-0**

#### Airport

Chief Chamberlain presented the Airport Budget, and explained the addition of an airport manager position.

Councilor Koloski noted he was unsure if adding this position is the right thing, but doesn't want to see the fire chief splitting time between the airport and the fire department.

Mayor Girard asked about the job description, Manager Manale and Chief Chamberlain explained the position would be around twenty-eight hours a week. Mayor Girard stated he is not

against the airport manager position, but doesn't think the plan is ready.

Councilor Koloski noted being more comfortable with a presented job description.

**Council agrees by consensus to move the airport budget to the June 14<sup>th</sup> Council meeting.**

#### Planning & Development

Director Merrill presented the Planning and Development budget to Council.

Director Merrill added the department was created about 20 years ago and merged a number of positions in the city for development.

Director Merrill noted a change that stands out, which is the new car lease, and rents and leases increased. Currently the Planning and Development Department is operating with a vehicle that's about six years old, and came from the Fire Department.

Building Maintenance and Repairs; Director Merrill mentioned \$11,000.00 is for insulation for the attic where it is losing a lot of heat.

Under personnel, two retirements are scheduled for this year, a part-time admin in the summer and the City Planner in January.

Councilor Stone questioned the change for marketing, Director Merrill explained in the past marketing has been posted to the wrong line item in the budget.

Councilor Contois shared concern losing the City Planner, and asked how to move proactively to look for a new City Planner. Director Merrill stated the search will be starting this summer to hopefully have a few months of training.

Mayor Girard noted the regular pay line item had a 15% increase from last year, and the part-time line item went up 30% and asked if there were many projects.

Director Mulholland stated part-time employees were added in the full-time line, \$23,467.49 needs to be removed from the full-time line.

Director Merrill added asking Bruce Temple to come in part-time because Planning and Development needed a project manager, since then Avery was hired full time. Mr. Temple is willing to stay on for a few months for the North and Main project, and to help train.

Councilor Koloski wants to add \$2,500.00 to membership and dues for the upper valley support position.

**By consensus the Council agrees to add \$2,500.00 on membership and dues.**

Councilor Contois stated he expects the City Manager and Planning Director to determine when Mr. Temple would no longer be needed and thinks the position should be left.

Councilor Stone suggested removing the position and look into it during the encumbrance Budget.

**By Consensus the Council Agrees to remove \$18,000.00 out of part time line item and bring back as encumbrance**

**By Consensus the Council Agrees to leave marketing as is.**

**A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to tentatively approve the Planning and Development for \$902,148.00**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**

**Koloski - yes**

**Matteau - yes**

**Stone - no**

**Batchelder - yes**

**Girard - yes**

**Motion Carried 7-1**

**TIFD-Downtown**

Director Merrill presented and reviewed the TIFD Budget, and noted significant repairs in parking garage as well as hiring a company to do cleaning and snow plowing so it wasn't done by DPW.

Assistant Mayor Matteau mentioned DPW used to do a lot of services, but are now contracted out. Assistant Mayor Matteau would like to see list of services from the past ten years on services that were once done in house that are now contracted out.

Councilor O'Hearne entered the meeting at 10:21 A.M.

**A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to tentatively approve the TIFD Budget for \$795,409.00.**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**  
**Koloski - yes**  
**Matteau - yes**  
**Stone - no**  
**Batchelder - yes**  
**O’Hearne - Abstain**  
**Girard - yes**  
**Motion Carried 7-1, (1 Abstain)**

*City Administration (Finance)/Finance/IT*

Director Mullholland presented the City Administration and Finance Budget, and explained the increase to salaries are due to the reorganization of positions, and added a part-time clerk for Central Collections. Consulting services are increased due to training and software. Tax deeding hasn’t been done in several years so an increase for anticipated advertising and reporting fees. There is a decrease in IT and M&R, they have been moved to general services.

**A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively approve the City Admin, Finance/IT Budget for \$842,473.00.**

**Roll call:**  
**Mooshian - yes**  
**Contois - yes**  
**Limoges - yes**  
**Koloski - yes**  
**Matteau -yes**  
**Stone - yes**  
**Batchelder - yes**  
**O’Hearne - yes**  
**Girard - yes**  
**Motion Carried 9-0**

*General Services*

Manager Manale and Director Mulholland presented the General Services Budget, and noted the following changes: and increase in legal for our contract with Attorney Feleen, legal settlements and codes have increased, an increase for abatements due to the re-evaluation, BS&A Support, Consulting Services for Merchant McIntyre, and Primex rates have increased.

Councilor Koloski asked about Council legal services, and stated it would be prudent to put funds into it.

**By Consensus Council agrees to move \$10,000.00 to the Council Legal Services line item.**

**A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively approve the General Services Budget for \$1,514,648.00.**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**

**Koloski - yes**

**Matteau -yes**

**Stone - yes**

**Batchelder - yes**

**O'Hearne - yes**

**Girard - yes**

**Motion Carried 9-0**

Police

Chief Wilmot read the Claremont Police Department's mission statement, and presented the Police Budget to the Claremont City Council. Chief Wilmot expressed gratitude to Council for support.

Councilor Stone noted there were hard decisions made, like the reduction of staff, and suggested once staff is filled to come back to Council for additional staff.

Assistant Mayor Matteau agreed it was a tough decision to take three positions out of the budget, and noted the difficulty to recruit and retain employees. Assistant Mayor Matteau stated not being comfortable a reduction that large, and asked the Chief to come back to Council if having issues.

Mayor Girard questioned why the animal control line that was requested compared to spent are different. Chief Wilmot stated there is a reimbursement through the Cost of Care Act. When the Police Department gets involved with criminal pet care or veterinary care, the Police Department will aggressively go after these funds now that they are aware.

Councilor Koloski mentioned the PD is the only department that doesn't submit anything to planning for the CIP. Manager Manale stated going forward IT and police will be submitting.

**A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to tentatively approve the Police Budget for \$2,949,888.00**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**  
**Limoges - yes**  
**Koloski - yes**  
**Matteau -yes**  
**Stone - yes**  
**Batchelder - yes**  
**O’Hearne - yes**  
**Girard - yes**  
**Motion Carried 9-0**

Communication 911

Chief Wilmot presented the Communications 911 Budget to the council, and noted the most junior communications employee has 3 years of experience, and finding stable part-time help is tricky, but is pleased to report there is an applicant in the final step of the hiring process.

**A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to tentatively approve the Communication 911 Budget for \$597,131.00**

**Roll call:**  
**Mooshian - yes**  
**Contois - yes**  
**Limoges - yes**  
**Koloski - yes**  
**Matteau -yes**  
**Stone - yes**  
**Batchelder - yes**  
**O’Hearne - yes**  
**Girard - yes**  
**Motion Carried 9-0**

Sanitation

Director Gleeson and Assistant Director Wadliegh presented the Public Works Budget starting with sanitation.

Director Gleeson brought attention to Building and Facilities M&R as there is an increase on monitoring due to the rubber membrane under soil, so there is no leeching, and landfill mowing.

Councilor Stone asked if this has this been an easy transition.

Director Gleeson explained for the City it has been easy by reallocating staff, but the beginning of the transition was rough, now there seems to be a nice flow.

**A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to tentatively approve the Sanitation Budget for \$25,800.00.**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**

**Matteau -yes**

**Stone - yes**

**Batchelder - yes**

**O'Hearne - yes**

**Girard - yes**

**Motion Carried 8-0**

#### Cemetery

Director Gleeson explained the Cemetery Budget to council, noting there are five cemeteries. Director Gleeson shared the changes were the increase on temporary and seasonal positions, and mentioned it has not been successful in retaining summer help. Increase in training and development for new employees, an increase to gas and diesel prices, and a vehicle replacement for a new backhoe.

**A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to tentatively approve the Cemetery Budget for \$173,768.00**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**

**Matteau -yes**

**Stone - yes**

**Batchelder - yes**

**O'Hearne - yes**

**Girard - yes**

**Motion Carried 8-0**

#### Streets and Roads (Highways)

Director Gleeson presented the Streets and Roads Budget to the Council by a power point presentation

Mayor Girard shared concern for potentially frontloading eight-to-ten-year leases, and equipment running out in six years, noting long term plans are great, but is afraid of replacing the equipment all at the same time.

Mayor Girard asked how OCI's are being graded, Director Gleeson explained its based on the visual, and also what materials are around the road.

Councilor Stone mentioned the difficulty getting certain colors for vehicle replacements, and asked if there was a better course of action and suggested standard coloring.

Director Gleeson stated there is still a truck at Ford waiting to be painted that was ordered last year, and the new tactic is to use state bids for some of these trucks and have them wrapped.

Mayor Girard asked to come up with a standardized color before making a change, and to look at insurance statistics for color and gave an example of red being a "dangerous color" according to some insurance.

Councilor Koloski asked about the zero' d out items (last two) on the budget footnotes. Manager Manale stated the notes are wrong and the amount is in the actual budget. \$2,300.00 for the Printer and \$4,000.00 for the machine.

**A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to tentatively approve the Streets and Roads Budget for \$3,534,946.00.**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**

**Koloski - yes**

**Matteau -yes**

**Stone - yes**

**Batchelder - yes**

**O'Hearne - yes**

**Girard - yes**

**Motion Carried 9-0**

Parks

Parks and Recreation Director Lawarence presented the Parks Budget.

Councilor Limoges shared concern about multiple playgrounds, Director Lawrence noted this was being taken care of.

Mayor Girard suggested moving parks maintenance into DPW from an efficiency standpoint to be looked at in the future.

Councilor Stone questioned the increase of special events, Director Lawrence noted Parks and Recreation are reallocating funding from arrowhead for special events like the 2<sup>nd</sup> Saturdays, 4<sup>th</sup> of July, and winter fests.

**A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively approve the Parks Budget for \$484,739.00.**

**Roll call:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**

**Koloski - yes**

**Matteau -yes**

**Stone - yes**

**Batchelder - yes**

**O’Hearne - yes**

**Girard - yes**

**Motion Carried 9-0**

CSB Community Center-Recreation

Director Lawrence presented the CSB Community Center Budget, after discussion **by consensus Council agrees to bring back this budget to the June 14<sup>th</sup> Council meeting** because the Council wants to review the final consultant report before tentatively approving this budget.

Municipal Complex (Maintenance)

Maintenance Superintendent Willette presented the Municipal Complex Budget and is asking for another Maintenance Position to be added, Mr. Willette noted being by himself faces many challenges, and is always being called in different directions. Mr. Willette did note that the department used to have two part time positions. There is also a need for admin work and grant set up. Mr. Willette stated a full-time person with skills would be important and would help with succession planning.

Council shared concern for having required licenses and permits for the work being done.

Manager Manale strongly suggested if the position isn’t approved to encourage increasing M&R significantly.

Councilor Stone suggested moving this onto the June 14th meeting.

**By consensus Council agreed to move Municipal Complex Budget to the June 14<sup>th</sup> Council meeting.**

**CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL**

None.

**ADJOURNMENT**

**At 1:40 p.m. a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.**

**Voice Vote:**

**Mooshian - yes**

**Contois - yes**

**Limoges - yes**

**Koloski - yes**

**Matteau -yes**

**Stone - yes**

**Batchelder - yes**

**O'Hearne - yes**

**Girard - yes**

**Motion Carried 9-0**

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro  
Clerk to the Council